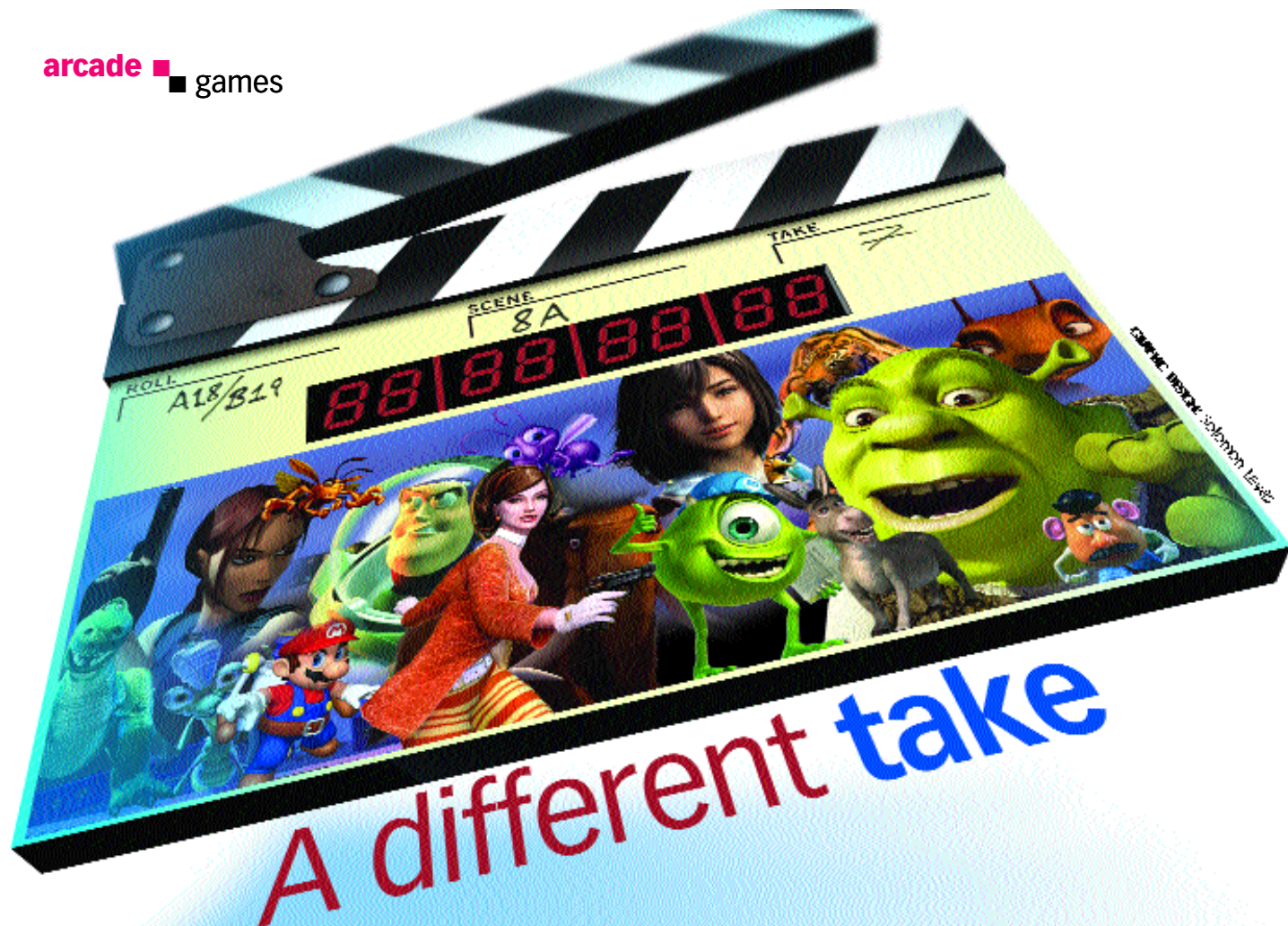




The next animated movie you see might be powered by *Quake III*!

"God how I hate Thursdays," swore Matt under his breath as he drove into the driveway. "I'm late, the crew must be waiting for me." Sure enough they were all there, three of them hunched up in front of their glowing monitors. They had already booted up *Quake II* and were fooling around on the map that served as their movie set. John sat on the floor, biting his nails, with the sketched storyboards scattered all around him. Hugh, was predictably watching the *Road Runner Show*, his fountain-head of inspiration. Their tired eyes gleamed with excitement.

Matt took the vacant seat and his camera—a Pentium computer running *Quake II* with the help of a 3D graphics accelerator. The map that the game was running looked like a diner: this was the set of their movie; this is where the magic happened. Ben's avatar was seen gleefully bunny-hopping inside the diner, while Paul's character gave chase, axe in hand. "All right guys, settle down. Its show time", whispered Matt. The chase ended abruptly as Paul guided his avatar to the assigned position where Frank's character already stood waiting; Ben took his place behind the counter. "Quiet on the set," said Matt. Someone chuckled; a 'roll tape' started an audiocassette

that contained the pre-recorded dialogues for the movie. Matt readied his camera-control keys, "Action." Ben pressed the [W] key on the

keyboard and used his mouse to deftly move his avatar up to the counter, Frank followed suit and pressed the [T] key, triggering a talking animation that synched perfectly with the dialogue that filled the air. It was going to be a long night, thought Matt, but their movie should be over by the weekend. Maybe Thursdays weren't all that bad after all.

Reel life heroes

Machinima is a movie-making technique that blends the flexibility of computer-generated (CG) animation with the speed and freedom of traditional movie techniques. It is an ingenious means of using a 3D game engine to create a low-budget animated film in minimum time. To a

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Both *Star Trek: Elite Force* (above) and *Deus Ex* (right) have used Machinima to great effect



Comedy in Armour
Hardly Workin'
Find trailers of
these Machinima
movies on the
Playware CD in Arena\Movies

